

Camila Isabel Aguirre Díaz

Development economics | Applied microeconomics | Causal Inference



Contact

Phone: +49 (0) 176 75459679
Email: cami_isa16@hotmail.com
Address: Munich, Germany
Web: <https://camila-aguirre.github.io/>

Research interests: Development economics; Climate and environmental economics; Migration; Agricultural economics; Labour Economics; Statistical Quality

Research Experience

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| Jan 2026 – present | Research Assistant (Wissenschaftliche Hilfskraft) – Department of Climate and Development Policy
RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Essen – Germany
Research project: Senegal Migration Panel <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Assess the impact of climate variability on migration in rural Senegal by combining satellite rainfall data with household panel data.- Develop and validate climate shock indicators for 143 villages to evaluate the effect of “false starts” (dry spells after the first rains of the sowing season) on household migration.- Conduct robustness analyses with alternative climate-shock definitions, precipitation datasets and model specifications to test the sensitivity of the estimates.- Create maps and visualisations in R and Stata of spatial patterns of climate exposure and migration. |
| Aug 2024 – Dec 2025 | Student Assistant (Studentische Hilfskraft) – Department of Climate and Development Policy
RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Essen – Germany
Research project: Senegal Migration Panel <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Co-designed and implemented a panel survey of 4,600 rural households (questionnaire development, pretesting, field monitoring, interviewer training).- Programmed automated data validation, cleaning and monitoring, reducing manual work and error rate by 70%.- Quality-checked and improved 800+ questions across three survey instruments.- Conducted independent academic research, analysing and comparing farmers’ perceptions of rainfall quality and measured weather data.- Structured data from 447 studies and created network visualisations for an RWI working paper. |
| Mar 2018 – Jan 2019 | Student Research Assistant – Faculty of Economics and Business Administration
Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito – Ecuador
Research project: Sources of the reproduction of inequalities in Ecuador <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Literature reviews and quantitative analyses of census microdata on welfare programmes, social security benefits and social mobility. |

Education

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| Oct 2023 – Nov 2025 | M.A. Development Studies (Economics) , University of Passau, Passau <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Final grade: Good (2.2).- Master’s thesis: Climate variability and agricultural conditions in Senegal: a critical comparison of farmers’ local weather perceptions and real weather data. |
| Apr 2023 – Sep 2023 | Intensive Course “German as a Foreign Language” (624 training units) , Carl Duisberg Centrum, Berlin <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Preparatory language course under the DAAD Helmut Schmidt Programme. |
| Oct 2020 – Feb 2022 | Master’s Degree in Economic Analysis , Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (UOC), Barcelona <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Final grade: Good (8.9/10).- Master’s thesis: Analysis of the Dynamics and Structure of the Ecuadorian Labour Market during the Period 2007–2019. |
| Jul 2014 – Mar 2019 | Double Bachelor’s Degree in Economics / Economics and Management , Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito / Université Grenoble Alpes, France <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Final grade: Very Good (9.0/10), 5 out of 27 graduates in the class.- Bachelor’s Thesis: Effect of relative income on women’s health status globally, during the years 2000–2015. |

Publications

- National Institute of Statistics and Censuses of Ecuador (2020). Methodology of the national survey on family relationships and gender-based violence against women. Co-author.

Contributions to Research Papers

- Climate data preparation and empirical analysis for: Haveresch, Sievert & Sall (2026). “False Starts, Fewer Departures: Early-Season Dry Spells and Migration in Rural Senegal”, RWI Working Paper.
- Literature review and network visualisation for: Haveresch, Ankel-Peters & Bensch (2025). “A Slippery Slope: Topographic Variation as an Instrumental Variable”, RWI Working Paper.
- Literature review and census data analysis for: Granda Benítez (2017-2018). “The Influence of the Economic Crisis of the 1980s on Inequality of Opportunity in Primary and Secondary Education in Ecuador”, PUCE.
- Technical contribution (Strategies section) to: United Nations (2022). “Guidelines on Quality Assurance Frameworks for Statistical Processes and Outputs”.

Awards and Scholarships

2023–2025	DAAD Helmut Schmidt Programme, Public Policy and Good Governance, 10 out of 800 applications.
2020–2022	SENESCYT “Common Globe” Scholarship.

Teaching Experience

Apr 2019 – Apr 2020	Academic Coordinator and Lecturer in Mathematics (part-time) , Advanced Studies Centre (CEAV), Quito.
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Professional Experience

May 2021 – Mar 2023	Senior Statistical Analyst (Team Lead) – Department of Statistical Quality National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador - Led an eight-person team developing 200+ quality indicators for 33 national statistical operations, the first systematic monitoring framework for official statistics in Ecuador. - Monitored the quality of Ecuador’s 2022 Census (16.9M inhabitants, 6.6M dwellings), preventing measurement error and bias. - Managed quality certification and monitoring tools for national surveys in line with international standards. - Represented the Statistical Office in UNSD and ECLAC working groups; contributed to a regional UN quality assurance guide for Latin America. - Developed gender- and social-disaggregated indicators for government planning and SDG monitoring.
Apr 2019 – Apr 2021	Junior Statistical Analyst – Department of Statistical Planning National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador - Coordinated with government bodies to develop indicators for national and international development frameworks. - Assessed information needs across 110 surveys, censuses and administrative sources to identify data gaps for national planning. - Organised workshops on socio-economic indicators for public institutions producing and using official statistics. - Contributed to national gender-statistics initiatives (questionnaire design, methodology, indicators, quality assurance).

Methods and Technical Skills

Quantitative methods and causal inference: Quasi-experimental designs; fixed-effects models; instrumental variables (IV); difference-in-differences (DiD); time series and cross-sectional data analysis; multinomial logit; Markov chains; robustness and sensitivity analysis.

Data and survey analysis: Large-scale datasets; questionnaire design; panel surveys; field monitoring; automated cleaning; geo-referenced and climate data; quality assurance (UN-NQAF/ISO).

Statistical programming: R, Stata, SPSS (very good); Python (good).

Data collection and visualisation: SurveyCTO, Power BI, Gephi (very good); KoboToolbox, Apify web scraping (good).

Data management and automation: SQL, Google Earth Engine, GitHub, n8n (good).

Languages

Spanish — native language English — C1 German — B2 French — B1

Language training: Berufssprachkurs, Berufliche Fortbildungszentren der Bayerischen Wirtschaft (bfz), Munich, Aug–Dec 2026 (ongoing).

Volunteer Work

Nov 2020 – Feb 2024	Youth representative , Sustainable Development Solutions Network Andes (SDSN), Quito
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***Note:** Additional training, certifications, and code samples are available on the website.*

Munich, 09 October 2026


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